Team Zara - The Coimbatore Case

Coimbatore is the option nobody in our class picked, which is exactly why we looked at it. The city has a large textile and engineering workforce that commutes short distances between residential colonies and factory clusters, and the weather is mild most of the year.

Our survey of 63 factory workers in Peelamedu found that 41 currently walk more than fifteen minutes to the nearest bus stop. A shift-timed scooter service could cut that walk to four minutes.

The catch is price sensitivity. Workers told us they would pay at most fifteen rupees a trip, about half of what VoltRide charges in Pune. That only works if employers subsidise the rides as a welfare benefit.

We therefore suggest a pilot co-funded by two large mills, with fixed morning and evening shift windows, and a review after ninety days.

Metric	Pune today	Coimbatore pilot
Scooters	1,800	200
Rides per scooter per day	5.1	6.0 (shift peaks)
Price per ride (Rs)	30	15 + 15 employer subsidy

Appendix

Survey questionnaire available on request. Interviews were conducted in Tamil and English during the second week of October.